Indian Knowledge Systems — Solved Answer Sheets

MBA Semester I • 2024 Pattern • Simple, exam-friendly English

Study note: Both uploaded IKS papers are combined into one subject-wise PDF. Every listed question and option is answered.

Answers include all visible questions and internal OR options in the uploaded paper(s).

May 2025 Paper

Q1(a) Significance of self-awareness in leadership from the Bhagavad Gita [2 marks]

The Bhagavad Gita teaches a leader to understand their strengths, weaknesses, emotions and duties. Self-awareness reduces ego, improves control over anger and fear, and helps a leader take fair decisions.

Q1(b) Servant leadership [2 marks]

Servant leadership means that a leader puts the needs and development of team members first. The leader listens, supports employees, removes obstacles and helps the team succeed.

Q1(c) Egalitarianism in western management theories [2 marks]

Egalitarianism means treating people as equals and giving them fair opportunities to share ideas and take part in decisions. It supports respect, participation and teamwork, regardless of job title.

Q1(d) Jugaad innovation and its importance in Indian businesses [2 marks]

Jugaad is a flexible, low-cost and practical way of solving a problem with limited resources. It helps Indian businesses create affordable solutions, use local materials and respond quickly to customer needs.

Q1(e) Shivaji Maharaj's resilience in adversity [2 marks]

Shivaji Maharaj showed resilience through courage, planning, adaptability and determination during difficult situations. He used knowledge of local geography, forts and swift military tactics to face stronger opponents.

Q1(f) Holistic and analytical decision-making [2 marks]

Holistic decision-making considers the whole situation, relationships, values and long-term effects. Analytical decision-making breaks a problem into parts and uses facts, data and logical comparison. Both approaches can be combined.

Q1(g) Role of social enterprises in local communities [2 marks]

Social enterprises use business methods to solve social or environmental problems. They create jobs, support local producers, provide useful services and reinvest part of their earnings in community development.

Q1(h) Vedas and their contribution to IKS [2 marks]

The Vedas are four ancient Indian texts: Rigveda, Samaveda, Yajurveda and Atharvaveda. They preserve knowledge about hymns, rituals, philosophy, values and early Indian thought, forming an important foundation of Indian Knowledge Systems.

Q2(a) Gita's teachings and team dynamics in a high-performance environment [5 marks]

The Gita encourages duty, self-control, cooperation and focus on work. (1) Clear duty: each team member understands their role. (2) Focus on effort: employees work sincerely without becoming obsessed with rewards. (3) Emotional control: calm behaviour helps during pressure. (4) Teamwork: people work for a shared purpose instead of personal ego. (5) Ethical conduct: decisions are made fairly. For example, a project leader can divide responsibilities clearly, listen to team members and focus on quality rather than blame.

Q2(b) How Shivaji Maharaj's leadership can inspire modern leaders [5 marks]

Shivaji Maharaj inspires modern leaders through strategic planning, courage, local knowledge, delegation and adaptability. He used forts and geography effectively and built systems for administration and defence. A modern business leader can study the market, use limited resources wisely, empower teams and change plans when conditions change. His example shows that preparation and people-focused leadership can help an organisation face strong competition.

Q2(c) Intuition in IKS and difference from data-driven decision-making [5 marks]

Indian knowledge traditions recognise intuition developed through experience, reflection and self-discipline. Intuition can help when time is limited or information is incomplete. Data-driven decision-making uses reports, measurements, statistics and models. Intuition is quick but may be affected by personal bias; data is more testable but may be incomplete or delayed. A good manager uses intuition to identify possibilities and data to test them before making an important decision.

Q3(a) Resilience and emotional intelligence inspired by the Gita in organisations [10 marks]

Introduction: Resilience is the ability to recover from difficulties, while emotional intelligence means understanding and managing one's own emotions and responding well to others. The Gita encourages steady-mindedness, self-control and performing one's duty. (1) Self-awareness helps employees recognise stress and limits. (2) Emotional control prevents angry reactions. (3) Resilience helps teams learn from failure and try again. (4) Focus on duty encourages effort and responsibility instead of fear of results. (5) Empathy improves communication and trust. (6) Calm leadership helps teams handle deadlines and change. Example: after a product launch fails, a manager can review mistakes without blaming staff, support the team and prepare a better plan. Conclusion: these values create a responsible, confident and cooperative team.

Q3(b) Karma and Dharma in modern corporations: work-life balance and ethics [10 marks]

Karma refers to action and its consequences. Dharma refers to duty, right conduct and responsibility. In a company, Karma encourages employees to work sincerely and accept responsibility for results. Dharma guides them to act honestly, treat people fairly and avoid harmful shortcuts. Applications include fair wages, honest advertising, safe working conditions, transparent decisions and respect for customers. For work-life balance, managers should set reasonable workloads, allow leave and respect family responsibilities. Employees should perform their duties responsibly without allowing work to damage health and relationships. Example: a manager should not force staff to hide product defects just to meet a sales target. Conclusion: Karma and Dharma can support ethical, balanced and sustainable business practices.

Q4(a) Community support and sustainability of family-owned businesses [10 marks]

Community support helps family businesses through customer loyalty, trust, local suppliers, referrals and informal financial or practical help. Local knowledge helps them understand customer needs. Community reputation can create repeat business across generations. Challenges include competition from large firms, changing customer tastes, limited finance, family disagreements and succession problems. Opportunities include local identity, personalised service, traditional skills, tourism, online selling and partnerships. A family food business, for example, can preserve a traditional recipe while selling through online platforms. It should maintain quality, professional accounts, clear family roles and a succession plan. Conclusion: community support is valuable, but long-term survival also needs innovation and professional management.

Q4(b) Principles and practices of Jugaad innovation [10 marks]

Jugaad is a resourceful, low-cost and flexible way to solve problems. Its main principles are (1) using available resources, (2) keeping solutions affordable, (3) adapting quickly, (4) focusing on the real customer need, (5) learning through experimentation and (6) making solutions simple. In a resource-limited setting, a small business may reuse safe materials, share equipment or use mobile technology instead of expensive systems. Benefits include lower cost, speed and local suitability. However, Jugaad must not compromise safety, quality, law or reliability. A temporary low-cost idea should be tested before wide use. Conclusion: responsible Jugaad encourages practical innovation when resources are limited.

Q5(a) Shivaji Maharaj as nation builder and entrepreneur [10 marks]

Shivaji Maharaj contributed to state-building through administration, defence, revenue systems and attention to local conditions. His leadership included strategic use of forts, mobility, intelligence and naval development. He organised people and resources to protect the state and trade routes. His approach shows innovation because he adapted methods to geography and the strengths of his forces rather than relying only on size. In modern management, these lessons mean planning carefully, developing local talent, protecting important assets, building reliable systems and adapting to changing conditions. As a nation builder, he encouraged political organisation and a sense of collective purpose. Conclusion: his example highlights strategic thinking, resilience and organised governance.

Q5(b) Adapting traditional family and community business practices to technology and globalisation [10 marks]

Traditional businesses often have trust, personal service, craftsmanship and strong community relationships. To adapt, they can (1) sell through websites and marketplaces, (2) use digital payments and accounting, (3) promote products through social media, (4) improve packaging and quality standards, (5) use customer data responsibly, (6) offer delivery and customer support, and (7) train the next generation in technology. For example, a local handloom business can keep traditional designs while selling to customers across India through an online store. It should preserve authenticity but meet modern delivery, quality and service expectations. Conclusion: combining tradition with technology helps family businesses grow without losing their identity.

May 2024 Paper

Q1(a) Role of values in decision-making [2 marks]

Values help a person decide what is right, fair and important. They guide choices, reduce unethical behaviour and build trust.

Q1(b) Define Karma [2 marks]

Karma means action and the consequences that follow from actions. It encourages people to act responsibly and thoughtfully.

Q1(c) Good governance [2 marks]

Good governance means managing an organisation or country with transparency, accountability, fairness, participation, efficiency and rule of law.

Q1(d) Work ethics [2 marks]

Work ethics are principles such as honesty, punctuality, responsibility, respect, discipline and commitment that guide behaviour at work.

Q1(e) Define Jugaad [2 marks]

Jugaad is a creative, flexible and low-cost way of solving a problem with available resources.

Q1(f) Succession planning [2 marks]

Succession planning is the process of identifying and preparing suitable people to take over key roles when current leaders leave or retire.

Q1(g) Name two leadership styles [2 marks]

Two leadership styles are autocratic leadership and democratic leadership. An autocratic leader makes decisions mainly alone, while a democratic leader involves the team.

Q1(h) Leadership traits of Shivaji Maharaj [2 marks]

Important traits included courage, strategic thinking, adaptability, discipline, foresight, justice, communication and concern for his people.

Q2(a) Dharma, Raj Dharma and Artha [5 marks]

Dharma means duty, moral responsibility and right conduct. Raj Dharma means the duties of a ruler or government, including justice, protection of people and fair administration. Artha means material well-being, resources, wealth and economic security. Good leadership balances all three: it follows ethical duties, protects society and manages resources effectively.

Q2(b) Hierarchical structures versus egalitarianism [5 marks]

A hierarchical structure has clear levels of authority and decisions usually flow from senior to junior staff. It can provide discipline and accountability but may slow communication. Egalitarianism emphasises equal respect, participation and open communication. It can encourage ideas and teamwork but requires clear responsibility. Many organisations combine hierarchy for accountability with egalitarian practices for discussion and respect.

Q2(c) Elements of ethical and efficient governance [5 marks]

Key elements are transparency, accountability, rule of law, participation, fairness, responsiveness, efficiency and ethical leadership. Transparency means sharing relevant information. Accountability means leaders explain their decisions. Rule of law ensures rules apply fairly. Participation allows people to contribute. Efficiency means using time and resources properly. Together these elements build public trust.

Q3(a) Shivaji Maharaj's leadership in contemporary management [10 marks]

His leadership offers lessons in strategic planning, delegation, resilience, local knowledge, innovation and accountability. He adapted military strategy to terrain and circumstances, used forts effectively and developed administration. Modern managers can apply these lessons by studying their environment, using resources carefully, empowering capable teams and preparing for risk. For example, a small company can compete with a larger rival by serving a local niche better and responding faster. His example shows that leadership depends not only on resources but also on planning, discipline and adaptability.

Q3(b) Jugaad innovator and conventional innovation models [10 marks]

A Jugaad innovator develops practical, affordable solutions using limited resources and quick experimentation. Conventional innovation often uses formal research, larger budgets, structured development, testing and long-term planning. Jugaad can be fast, flexible and locally appropriate; conventional models may be more systematic, scalable and quality-controlled. For example, a local entrepreneur may create a low-cost irrigation solution using available components, while a large company may develop a tested irrigation product through a formal R&D process. Jugaad must still meet safety and quality standards. Both approaches can complement each other.

Q4(a) Role of intuition and how to combine it with data [10 marks]

Intuition is a judgement based on experience, pattern recognition and quick understanding. It can be useful when time is short or information is incomplete. However, it can also reflect bias or overconfidence. Managers can improve decisions by stating the intuition clearly, collecting relevant data, checking alternative explanations, consulting others, running a small pilot and reviewing outcomes. For example, a shop owner may sense that demand for an item is increasing, then check sales records and customer feedback before increasing stock. A balanced approach uses intuition to suggest ideas and data to test them.

Q4(b) Implications of western work ethics on Indian organisational culture [10 marks]

Many western work practices emphasise punctuality, measurable performance, individual accountability, formal communication, equal opportunity and clear procedures. These can improve productivity, transparency and professional standards in Indian organisations. However, if applied without cultural understanding, they may conflict with relationship-based communication, family responsibilities or local working practices. Organisations should combine professional standards with respect, teamwork and cultural sensitivity. Flexible policies, fair performance measures and open communication can create a balanced culture.

Q5(a) Can family-owned businesses survive in today's competitive environment? [10 marks]

Yes. Family businesses can survive by preserving trust and customer relationships while adopting modern methods. They should improve product quality, use digital marketing and payments, maintain proper accounts, train family members, hire skilled professionals and plan succession. They must also manage family disagreements and avoid mixing personal and business finances. For example, a family-owned food brand can sell through e-commerce while maintaining its traditional recipes. Survival depends on innovation, customer focus and professional management.

Q5(b) Impact of technology and globalisation on business [10 marks]

Technology improves communication, online sales, automation, data analysis and customer service. Globalisation gives businesses access to new markets, suppliers, skills and investment. Both create opportunities for growth and lower operating costs. Challenges include global competition, cyber risks, changing customer expectations, supply-chain disruption and the need to meet international standards. Businesses should train employees, protect data, maintain quality and adapt products to local markets. Conclusion: technology and globalisation can increase competitiveness when managed carefully.